of a problem than the PPP. The PPP wants to govern and we should give them a chance to do so. They recognize that toppling Musharraf is not valuable, that Musharraf has history and experience. And, frankly, in talking to President Musharraf directly he wants peace and wants to work with the new government. Sharif has to be watched. I see no reason in moving forward for any actions against Musharraf. I think the people did do the right thing by restoring the judiciary.

I would like you to speak to this new proposed agreement and so we can understand it. The agreement is not being made with the terrorists per se, it is not the same as it was before, and I am talking now of the agreement that is being made with the tribal groups of the Mehsud area where the tribal groups have asked for Pakistan to make an agreement with them. They have asked for them to provide protection. They have asked for them to help them get rid of the Taliban and other insurgents and al-Qaeda. The agreement is an agreement from a position of power. The government is operating from a position of power.

So I do not think we should run away from Pakistan when it is making its own decisions to make peace. I think we should be monitoring it but we should look at it differently from the agreements that were made with the tribal areas before, even by Musharraf, that the PPP have a different perspective and they are doing it from a position of power. *Ambassador Pickring*, could you just in these waning minutes tell me how we treat Pakistan differently because you do have people there that love democracy and are prepared to move forward in moving their country forward, how do we deal with Pakistan?

Ambassador Pickring. Two things I think in terms of your very eloquent statement: One, certainly encourage the coalition government, the new civilian, democratically elected government, to move along the directions that both we and they agree that they should be moving. This has to be 50 percent made in Pakistan at least.

And secondly, as I said earlier, let us look at the agreements, let us look at the context and let us look at the construction. What is it that is there? Does it suit the common interests in Pakistan, Afghanistan, the United States? Fine; we should support it. If it does not suit those common interests then we should be very clear and we should make that clear to the Pakistanis as this process goes so we do not end up at the end of the day with take it or leave it. That is not the way I think to conduct the diplomacy here.

Ms. Jackson Lee. I thank you. And I think that is very instructive.

Thank you very much, Mr. Chairman.

Chairman Berman. The time of the gentlelady has expired. The gentleman from Colorado, Mr. Tancredo, is recognized for 5 minutes.

Mr. Tancredo. Thank you, Mr. Chairman.

An interesting mixed message that we hear here. On the one hand there is a need to retain the military in Afghanistan in order to, after we have essentially secured the country there is a need to have the military there to make sure that we have a civilian government in place that is competent and can take control. But on the other hand that is not an acceptable course of action in Iraq. Sort of a mixed message as I say.

More directly to the point of the problems we face in Afghanistan, Mr. Ambassador, I am perplexed and have been for a long time when we talk about countries that are steeped in traditions that only encourage corruption and we talk about ending the corruption, which is absolutely necessary of course to get to the next stage of civil government, but we say it as if there are these magic elixirs that we can use in the country in order to attain that. And yet I look around the world even as close as our southern neighbor and see the degree of the

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